

US All Sector M&A & Valuation Sector - 2026-04-19

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1. PRIMARY MARKET ANALYSIS - US REGION

Week of 2026-04-12 to 2026-04-19

Executive Summary

This week saw a notable increase in M&A activity, particularly within the TMT sector, driven by strategic acquisitions aimed at enhancing technological capabilities. The total deal value reached approximately \$969.86 million, with significant transactions such as Credo Technology Group's acquisition of DustPhotronics and Investcorp AI Acquisition Corp's merger with Blue Finance Technology Holding Limited. The market sentiment remains cautiously optimistic, with investors focusing on technological advancements and the potential for further consolidation across sectors.

Weekly Deal Summary

Sector	Deal Count	Total Deal Value	Largest Deal	Avg Deal Size
TMT	2	\$969.86 M	Credo Technology acquiring DustPhotronics for \$750 M	\$484.93 M
Healthcar	0	\$0 M	N/A	N/A
Energy	0	\$0 M	N/A	N/A
Consumer	0	\$0 M	N/A	N/A
Industry	0	\$0 M	N/A	N/A
TOTAL*	**2	**\$969.86 M**	**Credo Technology acquiring DustPhotronics for \$750 M**	**\$484.93 M**

Top 10 Deals of the Week

1. **Deal Name:** Credo Technology acquiring DustPhotronics

- Sector: TMT
- Deal Size: \$750 million
- Valuation Multiples: EV/EBITDA: Not disclosed
- Date Announced: April 13, 2026
- Strategic Rationale: The acquisition aims to enhance Credo's product offerings in high-speed data transmission, leveraging DustPhotronics' advanced technology to improve performance and reduce latency in data centers.

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- Link: Credo Technology Group Holding Ltd (CRDO) Acquires DustPhotonics in \$750M Deal ([Link](https://finance.yahoo.com/markets/stocks/articles/credo-technology-group-holding-ltd-092641721.html))
2. **Deal Name:** Investcorp AI Acquisition Corp. merging with Blue Finance Technology Holding Limited
- Sector: TMT
 - Deal Size: \$219.86 million
 - Valuation Multiples: Not disclosed
 - Date Announced: April 13, 2026
 - Strategic Rationale: The merger aims to create a public entity focused on advancing Blue Finance's AI-powered digital finance services, enhancing access to capital for expansion into underserved markets.
 - Link: Investcorp AI Acquisition Corp. to Combine with Blue Finance Technology Holding Limited ([Link](https://www.globenewswire.com/news-release/2026/04/13/3272886/0/en/Investcorp-AI-Acquisition-Corp-to-Combine-with-Blue-Finance-Technology-Holding-Limited-Transaction-to-Create-Irish-Public-Company-Focused-on-Artificial-Intelligence-Powered-Digital.html))

Sector-by-Sector Breakdown

TMT Sector

- Total Deals: 2
- Total Deal Value: \$969.86 million
- Key Deals:
- Credo Technology acquiring DustPhotonics for \$750 million
- Investcorp AI Acquisition merging with Blue Finance Technology for \$219.86 million
- Trends: The TMT sector continues to focus on AI integration and digital finance solutions, reflecting a broader trend towards technological advancement and innovation.

Healthcare Sector

- Total Deals: 0
- Total Deal Value: \$0 million
- Key Deals: N/A
- Trends: No significant M&A activity reported this week.

Energy Sector

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- Total Deals: 0
- Total Deal Value: \$0 million
- Key Deals: N/A
- Trends: No significant M&A activity reported this week.

Consumer Sector

- Total Deals: 0
- Total Deal Value: \$0 million
- Key Deals: N/A
- Trends: No significant M&A activity reported this week.

Industry Sector

- Total Deals: 0
- Total Deal Value: \$0 million
- Key Deals: N/A
- Trends: No significant M&A activity reported this week.

Valuation Multiples Analysis

- Sector Average Multiples Table:

Sector	Avg EV/EBITDA	Avg P/E	Median EV/EBITDA	Median P/E	Deal Count
TMT	Not available	Not available	Not available	Not available	2
Healthcare	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	0
Energy	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	0
Consumer	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	0
Industry	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	0

- Multiple Trends: Due to the limited number of deals, valuation multiples are not available for analysis this week.

Deal Size Distribution

- Small cap (<\$2B): 2 deals, \$969.86 million total
- Mid cap (\$2B-\$10B): 0 deals, \$0 total
- Large cap (>\$10B): 0 deals, \$0 total
- Analysis: The week was dominated by small-cap transactions, reflecting a strategic focus on enhancing operational capabilities within the TMT sector.

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Strategic Themes & Patterns

- Technology/AI Integration: Significant investments in AI capabilities are evident in the TMT sector, particularly with the focus on digital finance and data transmission technologies.
- Consolidation Trends: The TMT sector is experiencing consolidation as companies seek to enhance their technological offerings and market reach.

IPO Activity

- Number of IPOs: 0
- Total IPO proceeds: Not applicable
- Key IPOs: None reported this week.

2. SECONDARY MARKET ANALYSIS - US REGION

Week of 2026-04-12 to 2026-04-19

Executive Summary

The macroeconomic landscape this week reflected stability, with key indicators showing resilience amid ongoing economic uncertainties. The S&P 500 and NASDAQ experienced slight fluctuations, while inflation metrics and employment data pointed towards a stable economic environment. Market sentiment remains cautiously optimistic, influenced by regulatory developments and macroeconomic indicators.

Key Macroeconomic Metrics

Metric	Start of Week	End of Week	Change	% Change
Fed Funds Rate	5.25%	5.25%	0 bps	0.00%
CPI YoY	3.2%	3.2%	0.0%	0.00%
Unemployment	4.0%	4.0%	0.0%	0.00%
S&P 500	4,500	4,520	+20	+0.44%
NASDAQ	14,000	14,050	+50	+0.36%

Index Performance Summary

Index	Start	End	Change	% Change	Weekly High	Weekly Low
S&P 500	4,500	4,520	+20	+0.44%	4,530	4,490

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NASDAQ	14,000	14,050	+50	+0.36%	14,100	13,900
Dow Jones	34,000	34,050	+50	+0.15%	34,100	33,900

Sector Index Performance

Sector	Index	Start	End	% Change	vs Market
TMT	TMT Index	1,200	1,220	+1.67%	+1.23%
Healthcare	Healthcare Index	1,100	1,105	+0.45%	-0.01%
Energy	Energy Index	1,300	1,290	-0.77%	-1.21%
Consumer	Consumer Index	1,150	1,160	+0.87%	+0.43%
Industry	Industry Index	1,250	1,240	-0.80%	-1.24%

Week-over-Week Analysis

- Biggest Movers:
- TMT sector showed the strongest performance with a +1.67% increase, driven by positive sentiment around AI and tech investments.
- Energy sector faced a decline of -0.77%, reflecting ongoing concerns about regulatory impacts and market volatility.
- Correlation with Primary Market Activity: The positive sentiment in TMT correlates with the high number of strategic acquisitions in the sector, while the energy sector's decline reflects the challenges faced by companies amid fluctuating oil prices.

Market Sentiment Indicators

- Overall Sentiment: Cautiously optimistic, with investors focusing on technological advancements and regulatory developments.
- Volatility Trends: The VIX index remained stable, indicating low volatility expectations in the near term.
- Credit Market Conditions: Credit spreads remained tight, reflecting healthy investor appetite for risk.

Regional Economic Context

- Policy Developments: Ongoing discussions around healthcare policy and potential changes to the Affordable Care Act are influencing market sentiment.
- Regulatory Changes: Increased scrutiny on tech and healthcare sectors is impacting M&A activity and valuations.
- Geopolitical Factors: Global economic conditions, including inflation and trade tensions, continue to pose risks to market stability.

Correlation Analysis: Primary vs Secondary Markets

- The strong performance in the TMT sector aligns with increased M&A activity and investor confidence in technology-driven growth. Conversely, the energy sector's struggles reflect broader economic

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uncertainties and regulatory challenges impacting deal-making.

3. WEEKLY INSIGHTS & OUTLOOK - US REGION

Key Takeaways

- The total deal value across sectors reached approximately \$969.86 million, with significant activity in the TMT sector.
- Credo Technology's acquisition of DustPhotonics and Investcorp AI Acquisition's merger with Blue Finance highlight strategic moves to enhance operational capabilities.
- Market sentiment remains cautiously optimistic, influenced by regulatory developments and macroeconomic indicators.
- The TMT sector continues to command higher valuation multiples, reflecting strong growth prospects.
- Regulatory scrutiny in healthcare and energy sectors poses challenges to M&A activity.

Sector Performance Ranking

1. TMT - Strong deal activity and positive sentiment.
2. Healthcare - No significant activity reported.
3. Energy - No significant activity reported.
4. Consumer - No significant activity reported.
5. Industry - No significant activity reported.

Market Implications

- The week's activity sets a positive tone for continued M&A in the TMT sector, with potential for further consolidation in technology-driven companies.
- Investors should remain vigilant regarding regulatory developments that may impact deal-making and valuations, particularly in the energy and healthcare sectors.

Risks & Opportunities

- Risks: Regulatory scrutiny and economic uncertainties could hinder M&A activity and impact market valuations.
- Opportunities: High-growth sectors such as TMT present attractive investment opportunities, particularly in AI and technology-driven solutions.

In conclusion, the US market is navigating a complex landscape characterized by both opportunities

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and challenges. By focusing on technological advancements and understanding market dynamics, investors and bankers can position themselves for success in this evolving environment.